

CHAPTER 1

Understanding Social Science

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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🤔 Social Science in Everyday Life · Questions to think about

1 **Why do some people live in crowded cities while others live in scattered villages?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Cities offer jobs in industry, trade and services, plus schools, hospitals and transport, so many people move there.
- Villages are spread out because farming needs land, water and fertile soil near the home.
- Geography, history and economic choices together decide where people settle.

2 **Why do different communities speak different languages and follow different traditions?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Communities grew up in different places over thousands of years, each with its own environment and history.
- Languages, customs and festivals developed from these local conditions and were passed down through generations.
- Social Science explains such variations as outcomes of geographical, historical, cultural and economic factors.

3 **Why do some regions depend on farming, while others focus on industry or trade?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Regions with fertile soil, enough water and a suitable climate are good for farming.
- Regions near raw materials, power, ports or good transport develop industry and trade.
- History and government policies also shape what people do in a region.

4 **How do governments make decisions that affect millions of people?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- In a democracy, citizens elect representatives who make laws and policies.
- Governments study needs, discuss in institutions like Parliament, Assemblies and Panchayats, and then frame policies.
- Political Science studies how power is distributed, decisions are made and policies are implemented.

5 **Why are certain regions more prone to floods?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Low-lying areas near big rivers or the coast get flooded easily.

- Heavy monsoon rain, cyclones, melting snow and blocked drainage add to the risk.
- Cutting forests and building on riverbanks also make floods worse.

6 **Why does agriculture flourish in some regions but not in others?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Agriculture needs fertile soil, enough water (rain, rivers or irrigation) and a suitable climate.
- Plains with rivers (e.g., river valleys) flourish; deserts, steep hills and very cold areas find farming hard.
- Technology, markets and government support also matter.

7 **How does climate change influence our lives?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- It brings more heat waves, irregular rain, floods and droughts.
- Crops and farmers' incomes suffer, water becomes scarce and health problems rise.
- Some people may be forced to migrate. Social Science helps us find causes, effects and solutions.

⭐ Let's Analyse · Social Science in Everyday Life

1 **Observe your surroundings and identify a change that has taken place in your locality over the past five years (transport, housing, education, technology, or the environment). Discuss in groups:**

- **What was the situation earlier?**
- **What has changed?**
- **What might have caused this change?**
- **How has it affected people's lives?**

Prepare a short report and present it in class.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample report: A new metro / bus route in our area

- **Earlier:** People waited long for crowded buses or used autos; reaching school and offices took over an hour.
- **Change:** A new metro station (or bus route) started near our colony.
- **Cause:** The population grew, roads were jammed, and the government planned better public transport.
- **Effect:** Travel is faster and cheaper, pollution from vehicles is lower, shops near the station earn more. But some street vendors had to move and rents went up.

Write your own report about a change in your locality.

⭐ Let's Explore · Geography

1 **With the help of NCERT's School Bhuvan portal (https://bhuvan-app1.nrsc.gov.in/mhrd_ncert/), map your own village/city.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Open the School Bhuvan portal in a browser.
- Search for your village/city name or zoom in on the map.
- Locate your home, school, roads, rivers, fields and markets, and mark them.
- Note what you observe (e.g., where houses are crowded, where farms or water bodies are) and share it in class.

? Why Should We Study Social Science? · Questions in the text

1 **People around us speak different languages, follow diverse customs and practise varied occupations. Why do such differences exist within the same country? How do they continue over time?**

✔ ANSWER

- Such differences are outcomes of **geographical, historical, cultural and economic factors**.
- They continue because traditions and ideas are passed down through generations.
- Understanding them builds respect and cooperation, and Indian culture binds this diversity together through an underlying unity.

2 **How does the knowledge of Social Science help us in our lives?**

✔ ANSWER

- It explains how systems like housing, water, roads, schools and markets developed and how they affect different groups.
- It builds respect and cooperation among diverse communities.
- It prepares us to take part responsibly in civic life in a democracy.
- It teaches us to ask informed questions about issues like environment, health, jobs and urban growth.
- It connects the past, present and future, helping us make wiser choices.

🎉 **Chapter 1 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**